



# Mahmoud Adel

## Application Security & Offensive Security Engineer | B.Sc. Software Engineering

Application Security · Offensive Security Engineering · B.Sc. Software Engineering  
[mahmoudouf.com](https://mahmoudouf.com)

- Email
- LinkedIn
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Based in Egypt (UTC+2) · Open to Remote & Global Relocation  
Visa Sponsorship / B2B Contract  
[contact@mahmoudouf.com](mailto:contact@mahmoudouf.com)

### PROFILE

Cybersecurity Engineer driven by a deep fascination with low-level systems and system architecture. Inspired to enter the field early on, I developed a passion for understanding the "core mechanics" of technology—earning the moniker Kernel. From offensive mechanics to SOC defense, I view infrastructure security as an art form built on fundamental system principles.

20+  
HOF

\$1,REDACTED  
VERISIGN

Top 5/100  
CTF

Top 0.55%  
HACKTHEBOX

### EXPERIENCE

**Security Engineering Intern (Authorized Scope: Web/API & Network Assessment)** July 2024 – September 2024

#### Bastion Security — Security Engineering Internship

- Assessed **8 web apps** & **2 network ranges** in authorized scope — **11 validated findings** (auth bypass, injection, privilege escalation), 6 Linux + 4 Windows root validations.
- Validated every finding to root where applicable; documented **8 reports with 0 rework** — exploitation paths and remediation notes; presented for internal review.
- Validated via manual testing plus cloud posture checks (ScoutSuite / Prowler-style) in lab environment.
- Ranked **Top 5 of 100** in internal penetration-testing and privilege-escalation challenges.

[View Credential](#) → · Bastion Security internship certificate

#### Software Engineer Intern

Feb 2025

#### National Research Tomsk State University

- Delivered **2 prototypes + 12 diagrams** (UML/SDLC) — builds system reasoning for reproducible findings.

### SECURITY RECOGNITION & EVIDENCE

**Hall of Fame** — **20+ acknowledgments** via Bugcrowd ([bugcrowd.com/h/mahmoud\\_adel](https://bugcrowd.com/h/mahmoud_adel)) — Named: Verisign \$1,REDACTED CSRF → Account Takeover (DomainScope OAuth state, Apr 2018), DigitalOcean (Apr 2019), Pinterest & Dell (2018). **CRITICAL**

**Competitive & labs:** Bastion internal CTF **Top 5/100**; Hack The Box **Top 0.55% Pro Hacker** — verified badges; TryHackMe **Top 1%** — [@iamkernel](#). **VERIFIED**

**Detection & research:** ELK SOC Home Lab — 50k+ events, 5 Sigma MITRE-mapped, Kibana dashboards & triage workflow; IR malware triage (isolated Windows 10 VM, Sysmon/KAPE); AppArmor RCE mitigation; API security & AD attack paths. **LAB**

### SECURITY RESEARCH

- Verisign CSRF → Account Takeover** — Missing OAuth state → Google-link hijack → persistent ATO + password set (\$1,REDACTED reward, HoF Apr 2018). [Write-up](#) ↗
- AppArmor RCE Killswitch** — Deny /bin/\*\* + network → audit DENIED exec /bin/sh → allowlist containment + hardening. [Write-up](#) ↗
- ELK SOC Detection Engineering** — 50k+ events, 5 Sigma MITRE-mapped rules, Kibana dashboards & triage workflow. [Write-up](#) ↗

### CORE SKILLS

#### CORE

- Web/API Security
- Vulnerability Assessment
- Linux
- Windows
- TCP/IP
- Privilege Escalation (lab)
- Burp Suite
- Nmap
- Python
- Bash

#### APPLIED

- OWASP
- Network Security
- Active Directory
- Kerberos
- Wireshark
- BloodHound
- Impacket
- Docker
- System Administration
- Firewall
- SIEM (ELK)
- Incident Response
- MITRE ATT&CK
- Cloud Security (AWS IAM)

#### FAMILIAR

- Ghidra (lab)
- Metasploit (lab)
- Cobalt Strike (exposure)
- Sliver (lab)
- Nuclei (lab)
- SQLMap (lab)
- ffuf (lab)
- Malware Analysis (lab)
- Threat Intel (exposure)
- Exploit Dev (lab)
- Red Team (lab)
- YARA (lab)
- Sigma (lab)
- Suricata (lab)
- Splunk (lab)

#### ENGINEERING

- JavaScript
- C/C++
- Assembly
- SQL
- Git
- Presentation
- Problem Solving

### EDUCATION

**B.Sc. Software Engineering** — Conferred Jul 2026  
Tomsk State University  
Sep 2022 – Jul 2026

### CREDENTIALS & TRAINING

#### Blue Team Junior Analyst

SecurityBlue Team · 2023  
[Verify](#) ↗

#### Cyber Threat Intelligence

IBM · 2023  
[Verify badge](#) ↗

#### Jr Penetration Tester

TryHackMe · 2024  
[Verify PDF](#) ↗

Additional: OSCP (In Progress, OffSec) · PNPT (In Progress, TCM 2025) · Linux+ (2024) · CCNA (2023)

### PRACTICAL LABS & PLATFORMS

[Hack The Box](#) — [Verified Badges](#) · [Top 0.55% Pro Hacker](#)

[TryHackMe](#) — [@iamkernel](#) · [Top 1%](#)

### SELECTED WRITING

[\\$1,REDACTED CSRF](#) — [Verisign DomainScope ATO](#)  
[AppArmor RCE Mitigation](#)  
[ELK SIEM SOC Home Lab](#)

### LANGUAGES

**Arabic** · Native  
**English** · C2 Proficient  
**Russian** · C1 Advanced